

PREPARED SPEECH

2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ Participant is present
☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

CONTENT (30 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Introduction (X1)	Introduction is weak, with little effort made to highlight the theme and/or to generate interest and enthusiasm for the topic.	Effort is evident; introduction creates a moderate level of interest.	Introduction is effective, stimulating, and engaging; a strong effort is made to highlight the theme and/or to generate interest and enthusiasm for the topic.	
Body (X1)	Body of speech is poorly organized; content does not properly cover or represent the concepts and theme being presented.	Body of speech is adequately presented and is somewhat interesting.	Body of speech is clearly and effectively presented in an exceptionally interesting manner; the speech is memorable and conveys the theme.	
Conclusion (X1)	Conclusion fails to summarize or clarify the information presented in the speech.	Conclusion generally summarizes the content and theme of the speech.	The conclusion is effective, interesting, and memorable; the summary fully brings finality to the speech and the theme.	
CONTENT SUBTOTAL (30 points)				

STAGE PRESENCE (30 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Appearance (X1)	Participant's appearance is unprofessional, sloppy, and/or inappropriate.	Participant's appearance is adequate and appropriate.	Participant's appearance is clearly exceptional, appropriate, and professional.	
Confidence (X1)	Participant appears nervous during speech; poor posture, poor eye contact, and lack of confidence are evident; participant reads speech from note cards.	Participant is generally poised, displays eye contact, and is confident, with little sign of nervousness; participant's use of note cards is minimal.	Participant "commands" the room, and is exceptionally poised, confident, and positive; participant does not use note cards for the speech, or note cards do not detract from the overall speech.	

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STAGE PRESENCE (30 points) – continued				
Articulation (X1)	Participant conveys an inconsistent use of proper grammar, word pronunciation, acceptable pitch, and tone.	Participant generally uses proper grammar and pronunciation, and varies the tone and pitch in the delivery.	Smooth and effective articulation, proper grammar, correct pronunciation, and varied tone and pitch are used throughout the speech.	
STAGE PRESENCE SUBTOTAL (30 points)				

ORGANIZATION (40 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance 1-4 points	Adequate performance 5-8 points	Exemplary performance 9-10 points	
Effectiveness and Quality of Presentation (X2)	Speech is poorly prepared, not interesting, and not representative of the stated theme.	Speech is adequate in most areas but exceptional in none of them.	Speech is exceptional and memorable; the observer can easily understand and relate to the speech.	
Knowledge of Material (X1)	Minimal factual support is evident in the speech; the content of the speech does not relate to the theme; the participant does not convey understanding of the theme.	Factual support is provided in the speech, but the support does not always relate to the theme or match the content of the speech.	Factual support is provided in the speech; it has a strong relationship to the theme and enhances the content of the speech.	
Organization (X1)	The speech is difficult to follow or understand.	The speech is adequately organized and delivered.	The speech is clearly organized and easy to follow; the delivery is exceptional.	
ORGANIZATION SUBTOTAL (40 points)				

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____	
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TIME DEDUCTIONS		Record scores in the column spaces below.
One (1) point per ten (10)-second interval is deducted for speaking under three (3) minutes or over five (5) minutes. Time commences when the competitor begins speaking.		
TOTAL TIME FOR SPEECH		
TOTAL TIME DEDUCTIONS		

To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary.	TOTAL (100 points)
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Comments:

I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

JUDGE

Printed name: _____ Signature: _____